

Delaware County Commissioners, February 2nd, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oKY1ynwVpTI
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: February 2, 2026

Recording Start Time: [00:00:04](#)

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** The meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order at 9:03 AM [00:00:08](#) on February 2, 2026, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - Commissioner Henry (Present) [00:00:41](#)
 - Commissioner Brown (Present) [00:00:42](#)
 - Commissioner Reagan / Rean (Present) [00:00:43](#)

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board [00:00:12](#).
- **Employee Recognition:** [00:00:46](#) Building Superintendent Don Chambers presented Jenna Kalin as the Employee of the Month for the county building, praising her extensive assistance to maintenance, administration, and HR.

- **Board & Committee Openings:** [00:02:56](#) The board noted open positions, including a mayor's appointment for the Board of Health, a Democrat with a legal background for the Civic Center board, and a finance-oriented volunteer for the Fair Board.
 - **Approval of Prior Minutes:** [00:12:18](#) The board removed and approved corrected meeting minutes for December 15, 2025 [00:12:18](#), January 5, 2026 [00:12:46](#), and January 20, 2026 [00:13:19](#) by roll call vote.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **[00:04:04](#) American Tower Audit Lease Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Brooks
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed a lease amendment proposal from Landmark Dividend and inquiries to Crown Castle regarding a county-owned cell tower. Concerns were raised about locking the county into a 50-to-60-year lease under Option 3. Commissioners favored exploring shorter 15-to-20-year terms and revenue-sharing structures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from table and re-tabled for further deliberation by roll call vote.
- **[00:07:16](#) Withdrawal of Taxpayer Fee Ordinance (Ordinance 2025-37)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / Legal
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed withdrawing an ordinance regarding a taxpayer fee. Because the fee amount is strictly dictated by state statute and the matter falls under the purview of the council, the board elected to withdraw it.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Request to withdraw Ordinance 2025-37 approved by roll call vote [00:08:26](#).
- **[00:08:38](#) Bridge Vacation Ordinance (Ordinance 2025-32)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the vacation of a bridge and road north of the bridge on 200 West (just north of 400 South by Corinth Christian Church). Following the passing of the prior property owner, the new landowner purchased the parcels, intends to keep them agricultural, and adamantly requested the vacation to install a gate preventing illegal dumping.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Ordinance 2025-32 adopted by roll call vote [00:10:09](#).
- **[00:10:37](#) Secure Shredding Services Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Departments / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed department concerns from the prior meeting regarding container sizes, monthly collection frequency, and security oversight (including optional visual witnessing of shredding inside the truck).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Document shredding agreement with Secure Shred LLC approved as presented by roll call vote [00:12:02](#).

- **00:13:47 Baker Tilly Tax Analysis & Parcel-Level Detail Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Carol / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed a contract with Baker Tilly to provide data for a 5-year financial plan aimed at improving bond ratings. Commissioners debated potential costs, scope, and lack of a “not-to-exceed” clause. The parcel-level detail analysis component was priced between \$13,000 and \$18,000, with potential reductions if local schools participate.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved the parcel-level detail analysis up to \$18,000 by roll call vote [00:19:20](#).
- **00:19:35 Proud City Website Hosting Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle Johnson, Chief Information Officer
 - **Deliberation Summary:** CIO Kyle Johnson presented a contract for a new county website host because the current host (15 years old) is discontinuing services at year-end. The IT advisory committee unanimously recommended Proud City as the best value and service. Startup costs total \$35,500 and \$22,400 (one-time), with an annual cost of \$13,140.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved contract with Proud City by roll call vote [00:22:56](#).
- **00:23:25 600 South Bridge INDOT Coordination Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thomas
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An amendment to an INDOT coordination contract for an offline rural bridge. INDOT agreed to cover 100% of construction costs (\$1,428,400) except for \$3,100 in non-qualifying expenses to be paid by the county.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:24:15](#).
- **00:24:23 Cowan and Fuson Project Design Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thomas
 - **Deliberation Summary:** INDOT coordination design contract for a future roundabout at Cowan and Fuson, slated for construction letting in 2029.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved expenditure of \$497,072 from federal funds by roll call vote [00:25:05](#).
- **00:25:20 County Attorney Employment Agreement & Claims Management**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Attorney Mr. Brook
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual agreement for county attorneys. The hourly rate was adjusted to \$225/hour (noting standard private rate is \$375/hour). The agreement includes a \$35,000 set amount to internalize and manage county claims, tort claims, prisoner claims, and lawsuits in coordination with lower insurance premiums and higher deductibles (USI plan).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved employment agreement by roll call vote [00:29:07](#).
- **00:29:22 Ordinance 2025-38A (Principal Expert Annuity Plan Payroll Deductions)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Auditor’s Office

- **Deliberation Summary:** Introduces an amendment removing payroll deduction duties from the auditor's office for plans no longer county-sponsored, while retaining deductions for the Principal Expert Annuity Plan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Ordinance 2025-38A introduced by roll call vote [00:30:23](#).
- **00:30:33 Ordinance 2026-01: Activities Within Public Right-of-Ways**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Brook & Mr. Thomas
 - **Deliberation Summary:** First reading of an ordinance to amend Title 5, Chapter 14 regarding public right-of-way construction, last updated in 2000. It increases permit fees, passes additional engineering costs onto applicants, increases oversight for the highway department, and establishes fines and injunction remedies for contractor violations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Ordinance 2026-01 introduced by roll call vote [00:33:22](#).
- **00:33:34 Weights and Measures Ordinance (Chapter 15 Adoption)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading and adoption of an updated Weights and Measures ordinance updating definitions, technology adjustments, audit trails, and fee structures to improve compliance enforcement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted new Chapter 15 by roll call vote [00:34:50](#).
- **00:36:05 Claims, ARP, and Payroll Approvals**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The auditor noted a check duplication in sanitary payments totaling \$4,246.91 to be removed. Total regular claims amounting to \$3,215,649.54 (adjusted total) were reviewed, including various TIF bond payments, highway snow removal equipment, and road salt. 13 of 24 departments provided credit card substantiation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Regular Claims (\$3,215,649.54): Approved by roll call vote (Commissioner Brand voted No) [00:41:34](#).
 - ARP Claims (\$9,375.00): Approved by roll call vote [00:41:50](#).
 - Payroll (January 28th - \$1,801,550.48): Approved by roll call vote [00:42:04](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:42:38 Rita Faulner** (1515 West Bethel Avenue, Muncie): Addressed concerns regarding meeting minutes not being approved and published in a timely manner. Citing Open Door Law and the Public Access Counselor, she emphasized that draft minutes should be made publicly available promptly rather than waiting weeks for formal editing and adoption.

- **00:48:22 Rick Yenser** (Newsman, author, YouTube show host): Spoke about issues regarding AI altering public perceptions of meeting summaries, suggested exploring public bids for goods/services below the statutory threshold to increase openness, and commented on local government cash balances and cost-of-living concerns.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **HR Updates (00:50:27):** Josh Jarvis announced that the marathon clinic partnership with IU Health will begin on March 3rd.
 - **Commissioner Brand's Announcements (00:51:12):**
 - Highlighted the Weights and Measures annual report (14,375 inspections; 783 rejections; 39 red-tagged).
 - Noted upcoming employee handbook revisions and mandatory cybersecurity training compliance warnings.
 - Announced town hall meetings starting in Eaton on March 12th, followed by Cowan, Prairie Creek, and Daleville.
 - Announced a joint State of Our Community breakfast with the city at the Horizon Convention Center on March 5th.
 - Noted INDOT's regional roadway roundtable at Minatrista on March 13th.
 - Provided legislative updates regarding Senate Bills 179 and 142, and House Bills 1315 and 1342.
 - **Highway Department Update (00:57:51):** Commissioner Brown and Highway Superintendent Tommy Thomas thanked highway crews, EMS, and the sheriff's department for round-the-clock snow removal operations during the recent major snowstorm.
 - **Adjournment: 00:41:50** The meeting was motioned into recess/adjournment and approved by roll call vote **00:10:41**.
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